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Implement a Content Locker to Get More Leads



By **Chaz Wilke**, Staff Writer

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These days, everybody is trying to squeeze as much conversion potential from every piece of content online. But you understand the perils of attempting to game the system. You know that keyword stuffing is no longer effective. You know that buying links is a surefire path to penalization. So as a crafty affiliate marketer, you might want to consider a content locker.

What is a content locker?



So you've written a fantastic piece of content. One that is emotionally gripping, sharable and ready to take social media by storm. You may be concerned that just giving away such an important salvo of information is a waste. After all, someone can click on the link, read the content then just leave without converting.

This is where a content locker comes in. Consider it a monetizable addition to your conversion filter. "When used correctly, [content lockers] can be quite an effective way to grow your website, or even monetize certain posts," [says](#) Shaun Quarton at *Torque*.

If you've been to the Wall Street Journal site you've likely encountered a pay wall. This is the extreme end of content locking. Those sites want you to pay a monthly fee to access their content. Well, you likely don't want this for your site, but you might like a little extra information from your visitor or an extra chance to push ads to them. This is generally how affiliate marketers use content locking.

What are the benefits?

Content locking is so useful because you decide how it will be used. Some sites prefer to sign up for CPA affiliate networks that will present survey questions to the site's visitors to better qualify each visitor as a potential lead. Some present an ad requiring some level of interactivity from their visitor, like typing a word or phrase found within the ad.

Other forms of content lockers include opt-ins which request a visitor's email before releasing the desired content.

Also, you have the option of implementing a social share function in your content locker. You can request that your visitor share the content on his or her preferred social media platform before accessing the unlocked content. But Joe Fylan of WPsquared.com [warns](#), "If your content is lacking then no amount of good design, plugins, tips and tricks are going to increase your social shares."

How is it implemented?



There are a number of ways to implement a content locker on your affiliate site. Some may choose to work with CPA affiliate networks offering content locking as a method of servicing ads. Others may wish to use a content locker as a method of building their email lists.

• Content Locker Networks

There are a number of CPA affiliate networks that push ads to your content locker on your site. Once you sign up and provide the necessary information, you can monetize each piece of content on your site through pop-

up advertisements. Each advertisement may likely require some level of interaction from visitors to prove they've seen the ad.

• Opt-In Content Locker

If you wish only to build your email list, consider using an opt-in content locker. This method prevents visitors from accessing pieces of content you designate as "for subscribed users only." If you run your site on any of the popular content management systems, like [WordPress](#), there may be a simple plugin you can install to get up and running with an opt-in content locker.

Takeaway

A content locker's effectiveness is revealed through the value of the content you create and publish on your site. Your visitors must find some unique value in the content you are offering to be willing to jump through the hoops to unlock it.

If you are only providing basic, easily searchable information, then content locking may not be right for your site. But, if you've grown a following for providing unique and engaging content that your visitors can't find anywhere else, then a content locker may be worth investigating further.

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Chaz Wilke

Content Writer

Hailing from Chicago and a product of the Illinois public school system, Chaz Wilke is a professional writer who has written for newspaper, TV, radio, video games, blogs, and film. In his spare time, Chaz enjoys hiking and discovering the hidden gems and oddities of Los Angeles. He also juggles.

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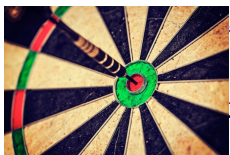
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D&D Marketing USA

4000 W. Alameda Ave, Suite 200

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